

Dear Readers,

We firmly believe that a product must constantly improve itself in order to add more value for its customers. Hence it's been our endeavour from the very inception of the magazine to provide you with the best product mix comprising of useful innovations from specialised booklets, free Linux distributions to specialised video workshops on the Digit CDs.

In this issue, we've tried something radically different by offering two Fast Forward CBTs (Computer Based Training CDs) along with the magazine.

A CBT offers us the opportunity to communicate and explain the finer nuances of computing while overriding some of the limitations of

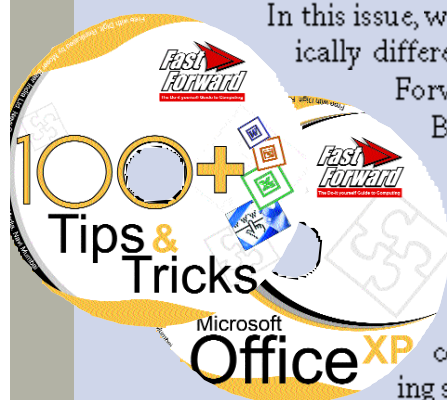
a print publication. The interactive nature of this medium allows you to learn at an accelerated pace while spending a minimal amount of time in the actual learning process.

We hope that you find the *100+ Tips & Tricks* and *Working with Office* CBTs useful learning companions. However, it's quite possible that we might have missed a trick or two in our enthusiasm to compile them. Thus, we would love to know your opinions and experiences with these two CBTs. Are you satisfied with their content quality? Would you prefer extra hands-on tutorials or more learning content?

Please log on to www.thinkdigit.com/fastforward and share your views with us. We would really like to hear from you.

Cheers,

The Digit Team



Driving bad sectors

Dear Vinit,
In the hard drive test conducted in the November issue, you have specified that by spending a little extra, we can get a 40 GB hard disk drive instead of a 20 GB. A friend of mine recently bought a 40 GB hard disk, which just a few days later developed some bad sectors. I have heard that most of the 40 GB hard drives easily get bad sectors as compared to 20 GB drives.

Venkatish
Via e-mail



Dear Venkatesh,

Your belief that 40 GB hard disk drives have a greater tendency to develop bad sectors is a fallacy. A simple case of bad luck might have more to do with your friend's drive crashing, than its 40 GB capacity (we've got a substantial number of similar capacity drives that are running completely trouble-free in our offices). The best way to avoid bad sectors is by taking necessary precautions such as refraining from moving the drive while it's in operation and providing clean, uninterrupted power to your computer.

digit

Branded Justice

Hi,

This is regarding your test on Branded PCs in the October 2002 issue of Digit. I was shocked to see Zenith's system, which was based on a 2.4 GHz Intel Pentium 4 processor, being outperformed by the 1.3 GHz Celeron based Vinton Elixir 1000. Could you please clarify this scenario?

Guruprasad
Via e-mail

Hi Guruprasad,

We tested the PCs in the same state in which they arrived in our test labs. Theoretically, a newsystem built with the same configuration as the Zenith PC should have performed much higher than the scores we logged. Thus it's possible that we received a faulty unit for testing, but we'd recommend that you stick with a more sturdy performer such as the HCL Bearstalk 4458 as detailed in our article.

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Your vote counts

Q. What do you think about Digit's unique half-flap covers?

For	Against	Gimme Models
34%	33%	33%

Since you are this undecided, we'll stick with the tried and tested for now.

This month's question:

"Would you replace Backbyte with a monthly technology quiz?"

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote on it